

Project Marking Rubric: Checkpoint 1

COMP 2659 – Winter 2025

Group: ?

Mark: ? / 100

Important Information for Students

The project is worth 40% of your final course grade, with the checkpoint 1 game specification comprising the first 6%. The overall project grade, including the mark for checkpoint 1, will not be finalized until after the April due date. The checkpoint 1 mark indicated here is *provisional*: groups are eligible to receive a higher checkpoint 1 mark if they make improvements to the final submitted game specification. That is, the checkpoint 1 mark may ultimately be higher. The final checkpoint 1 mark will not normally be lower, except as indicated below.

Penalties to the final project grade that affect the provisional checkpoint 1 mark only be applied if (a) the group makes changes to their final game concept that are not reflected in the final submitted specification, or (b) the group did not submit a complete initial specification by the January 26 deadline. Please be reminded that you are required to keep your specification up to date as you develop the remainder of the project. If you make changes to your game concept, ensure that these are reflected in the document.

Please see the course outline and project requirements documents for more information.

General Instructor Comments

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Rubric

1) Overview Section and Miscellaneous / 10

High-level game concept is clearly and concisely summarized (includes appropriate first screenshot)	/ 5
Specification document is clearly formatted, readable, and generally free of significant spelling and grammatical errors. All images obtained from other sources are properly cited	/ 5

2) 1-Player Details Section / 65

Objectives, Rules, and Physics (20 marks)

Essential components and characteristics of the game world are clearly introduced, and are illustrated somewhere in section 2 by an appropriate second screenshot	/ 5
Game starting state is clearly described, including the initial location and state of each object	/ 5
Rules are clearly and concisely summarized, including:	/ 10

• Rules governing player/opponent actions and their outcomes • Conditions for scoring/winning/losing • Details about turns/rounds/levels, if applicable In addition, game world's physical laws are clearly and concisely summarized, if applicable, potentially including: • Object velocity/acceleration/momentum • Collision detection • Rebounding • Gravity and other forces	
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Objects (20 marks)

Each object or object type is clearly identified, accompanied by at least one representative image	/ 4
Each variable object property is appropriately identified, including: • Name • Type Note: these are the fundamental data that describe the state of each game object (key constant properties are also identified where appropriate)	/ 8
Each object behaviour is appropriately identified Note: these are the fundamental actions that each object may perform throughout the game, according to their current state, and which potentially update that state (e.g., "move", "teleport", "turn", "fire", "take damage"). Behaviours are not the same as events, although a behaviour may trigger or be triggered by an event	/ 8

Events (20 marks)

Each asynchronous (user input) event is appropriately identified: • Including for all mouse/keyboard input • The specific triggering input identified • Key press and release events are distinguished, where appropriate • Event descriptions are clear and link explicitly to object behaviours/properties Note: keyboard input is required of all games; mouse input is also possible but optional (mouse input will be mandatory for the splash screen, but the splash screen is not covered by this specification)	/ 7
Each synchronous (timer-based) event is appropriate identified: • The specific trigger timing is identified • Key/button auto-repeat events are listed as synchronous events • Event descriptions are clear and link explicitly to object behaviours/properties	/ 7
Each condition-based event is appropriate identified:	/ 6

• The specific triggering condition is identified • Event descriptions are clear and link explicitly to object behaviours/properties Note: triggering conditions are typically detected as a result of carrying out object behaviours (which, in turn, may have been triggered by preceding events)	
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Hypothetical Gaming Session (5 marks)

Game play, rules, object characteristics, and events are coherently illustrated via a brief but helpful narration of a short sample game session	/ 5
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3) 2-Player Details Section

/ 10

Essential details of the 2-player version are provided, including: • Whether play is turn based or simultaneous • Whether play is cooperative or competitive • Any differences in rules or core gameplay • Any differences in start state, scoring, winning conditions, etc. • Any new objects or events • Appropriate third screenshot

4) Sound Effects Section

/ 10

An appropriate set of sound effects is identified, and each is clearly linked to a triggering event

5) Additional Features Section

/ 5

The core game (described in sections 1-4) is free of unnecessary enhancements not required for a minimally complete, playable game. As opposed to “need to have” features, all merely “nice to have” features are left to section 5
